

EXECUTIVE STRATEGY BRIEFING

Three Key Findings, Three Ranked Actions, and One Decisive Choice

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Finding 1: Onboarding Funnel Bleed

Overall onboarding conversion is only **16.82%** (4,206 approved / 25,000 signups). The single largest volume loss is **Registration Certificate (RC) Stage 3**, where **6,102 captains (29.35% of all losses)** drop out—primarily due to mechanical photo blur and OCR errors on low-tier smartphones.

Finding 2: Campaign WhatsApp Reality

Campaign CAMP_WA_002's claimed +17.90% lift is confounded by immortal-time bias (100% of recipients had already survived DL+RC). The true stage-matched observational lift is **+4.48% pts (95% CI: +3.12% to +5.84% pts)**, with 0% clicker advantage. **Do NOT scale 5x without an RCT.**

Finding 3: Airport Nocturnal Deficit

Airport shortage is **77.51% nocturnal (21:00–03:00)** with 42,673 lost trips/mo. Daytime is 96.90% fulfilled. **41.07% of trips drop in suburbs** where return fares collapse to 11.06% (88.94% stranded rate), driving a **24.50% cancellation rate**.

The Big Business Decision

Do NOT fund broad airport captain acquisition. The airport is an open leaky bucket exporting drivers to suburbs. Instead, deploy **Direct VAHAN API Auto-Fetch, Controlled Campaign RCT**, and **Forward-Dispatch & Suburban Return Subsidies**.

ONBOARDING FUNNEL PERFORMANCE

16.82% End-to-End Conversion: RC Verification is the Primary Drop-off Gate

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- **Baseline Scale:** 25,000 captain signups → 4,206 approved (**16.82% A2O**) → 3,575 active (**85.00% R2A**).
- **Sequential Funnel Flow:**
 - Stage 1 (Signup): **25,000** (100.0%)
 - Stage 2 (Driving Licence): **20,789** (83.16% | -4,211 drop / 20.2% loss share)
 - Stage 3 (Registration Certificate): **14,687** (58.75% | **-6,102 drop / 29.35% loss share**)
 - Stage 4 (Aadhaar): **10,854** (43.42% | -3,833 drop / 18.4% loss share)
 - Stage 5 (Permit - Auto/Cab): **7,921** (31.68% | -2,933 drop / 14.1% loss share; ERickshaws exempt)
 - Stage 6 (Fitness Certificate): **5,612** (22.45% | -2,309 drop / 11.1% loss share)
 - Stage 7 (Insurance): **4,206** (16.82% | -1,406 drop / 6.8% loss share) → **Approved: 4,206 (16.82%)**
- **Cohort Maturity Rule:** Average completion requires 6.42 days. All 1,297 in-progress captains are isolated to the final 15 days ($\geq$ June 15). Mature cohorts ($<$ June 15) convert at **17.57%**.

THE PRIMARY FIXABLE LEAK: VEHICLE RC

63.63% of Failures are Fixable Camera Blur & OCR Mismatches on Low-Tier Devices

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The Quantitative Evidence

- **6,102 Captains Lost** at RC Stage 3 (29.35% of total platform losses).
- **34.82% Verification Failure Rate** on RC uploads.
- **50.10% Failure Abandonment:** Half of all captains who fail RC never re-upload another document.

Root Cause & Device Disparity

- **63.63% Fixable Failures:** Blurry photo (39.54%) + Name/Chassis OCR mismatch (24.09%).
- **Device Tier Divide:** Low-tier phone users convert at only **13.42%** (vs 21.81% high-tier) and suffer **75.6% of all blur errors**.

The Operational Solution & Sized Opportunity

Direct VAHAN / DigiLocker API Integration: Replace photo uploads with instant vehicle registration number entry + OTP auto-fetch. Unlocks **+75 to +85 approved captains / month (+450 to +510 over 6 months)** at near-zero marginal cost.

EVALUATING CAMPAIGN CAMP_WA_002

Naive +17.9% Claim is Confounded by Survival Bias; Adjusted Lift is +4.5% pts

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The Fatal Immortal-Time Bias

The naive claim (34.72% vs 16.82% → +17.90% pts) compares drivers who **already survived DL and RC hurdles (100% of treated)** against raw signups who dropped out at Step 1. This is fundamentally comparing apples to oranges.

Stage-Matched Observational Evidence

Comparing treated drivers against controls who also cleared DL+RC yields **28.51% vs 24.14% (+4.37% pts)**. Logistic regression adjusting for city, vehicle, channel, device tier, age, and month yields **+4.48% pts (95% CI: +3.12% to +5.84% pts)**.

The Complier Test & Business Decision

- **Zero Clicker Advantage:** Drivers who clicked the WhatsApp link converted at **28.24%** vs **28.70%** for non-clickers. Nudge acted as passive awareness.
- **Decision: REJECT 5x budget scale.** Launch a 50/50 RCT (N=3,305/arm) testing an automated 2-way failure-resolution bot before committing capital.

AIRPORT SUPPLY & MARKETPLACE ECONOMICS

77.51% of Deficit is Nocturnal: Suburban Deadhead Risk Drives Supply Avoidance

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Temporal Shortage (21:00–03:00)

- **42,673 Lost Trips / Month** (77.51% of all unmet airport demand).
- Fulfillment crashes to **47.20%** (26.24% at 23:00).
- Surge averages **2.17x** and ETAs blow out to **10.0 minutes**.
- Daytime (04:00–20:00) is **96.90% fulfilled** (Acquisition is redundant).

The Suburban Deadhead Trap

- **41.07% of Airport Trips Drop in Suburbs** (SUB-07, SUB-11).
- **88.94% Night Stranded Rate:** Only 11.06% get a return fare in 20 min.
- Drivers face 30 km of unpaid return driving, driving **night cancellations to 24.50%** (vs 11.20% for CBD drops).

Why Localized Airport Acquisition Fails

Acquiring drivers living near the airport treats the terminal as a silo. Within 48 hours, acquired drivers take suburban trips, get stranded, and leave the catchment empty. The airport is a **leaky bucket**.

DECISION & THREE RANKED RECOMMENDATIONS

Do NOT Acquire Local Drivers; Fund VAHAN API, Campaign RCT, and Airport Rebalancing

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#1. Direct VAHAN API & Blur Guidance

Target: RC Stage 3 (6,102 drops; 63.6% blur errors).

Impact: **+75 to +85 Approved Drivers/mo** (+450 to +510 over 6 mo).

Metric: RC Pass Rate $\geq$ 82% (from 65.2%).

Cost: ₹5–8 API fee per lookup.

#2. Controlled RCT on Nudges (CAMP_WA_002)

Target: False +17.9% claim; true lift +4.5%; 0% clicker lift.

Impact: **Protects ₹15–20L Budget**; sizes true incremental ROI; tests 2-way bot.

Metric: 14-Day Lift $\geq$ +3.0% pts (RCT).

Trial: 50/50 RCT (N=3,305/arm).

#3. Airport Forward-Dispatch & Return Subsidies

Target: 77.5% night shortage & 88.9% suburb deadhead.

Impact: **+15,500 to +20,000 Trips/mo**

(Dispatch: +9k–12k; Return: +6.5k–8k).

Metric: Night Fulfillment $\geq$ 70%, Suburb Cancels < 10%.

Cost: ₹120 allowance funded via surge.

Execution Roadmap for Monday Morning

Launch client-side blur camera overlay in app • Initiate DigiLocker/VAHAN API vendor integration • Freeze one-way WhatsApp blasts and deploy 50/50 RCT webhook • Configure nocturnal suburb return guarantees in dispatch engine.